

Amendment No. 1 to HB1977

White
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 2156

House Bill No. 1977*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-4-701(b)(1), is amended by deleting the subdivision and substituting:

(1) "Approved EPP" means an educator preparation program approved by the state board of education;

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-4-701(b)(2), is amended by deleting the subdivision and substituting:

(2) "Eligible candidate" means a student who is:

(A) Enrolled in an approved EPP:

(i) In the student's junior or senior year as determined by the institution in which the student is enrolled as an undergraduate student;

(ii) As a post-baccalaureate student, if the student is seeking an initial educator license; or

(iii) And making progress toward completing the clinical experience required pursuant to § 49-5-5604; and

(B) A citizen of the United States who has resided in this state for at least one (1) year prior to the student's enrollment in an approved EPP;

SECTION 3. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-4-701(b)(3), is amended by deleting the subdivision.

SECTION 4. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-4-701(d), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting:

(d) To be eligible for a Tennessee Future Teacher scholarship, an eligible candidate is only required to meet the following criteria:

- (1) Be admitted to and enrolled in an approved EPP;
- (2) Submit proof of enrollment in an approved EPP to TSAC;
- (3) Complete the scholarship application, as required by TSAC; and
- (4) Sign a promissory note agreeing to teach in an LEA or public charter school in this state for at least two (2) consecutive years in a targeted setting.

SECTION 5. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-4-701(g), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting:

(g) An eligible candidate who receives a Tennessee Future Teacher scholarship may transfer from one (1) approved EPP to another approved EPP without loss of the scholarship as long as the eligible candidate continues to meet all eligibility requirements for the scholarship.

SECTION 6. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-4-701(h), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting:

(h) Subject to the amounts appropriated by the general assembly, the amount of the Tennessee Future Teacher scholarship is seven thousand five hundred dollars (\$7,500). A Tennessee Future Teacher scholarship may be awarded to an eligible candidate each academic year the eligible candidate is enrolled in an approved EPP.

SECTION 7. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 5, is amended by adding the following as a new part:

49-5-1201. Short title.

This part is known and may be cited as the "Tennessee Teacher Residency Pilot Program Act."

49-5-1202. Part definitions.

As used in this part:

- (1) "Department" means the department of education;

(2) "Educator preparation provider" or "EPP" means an educator preparation provider approved by the state board of education;

(3) "Partnering LEA or public charter school" means an LEA or public charter school that is formally partnering with an EPP or nonprofit education preparation provider to operate a residency program;

(4) "Residency program" means an education-related organization or 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization that conducts teacher preparation training using a residency model in partnership with an LEA, postsecondary institution, or EPP;

(5) "State board" means the state board of education; and

(6) "Teacher resident" means an aspiring educator who is participating in a residency program to complete the requirements for an initial educator license.

49-5-1203. Tennessee teacher residency pilot program established –

Administration.

(a) The department shall develop and administer a three-year pilot program to support residency programs by awarding grants to such programs pursuant to this part.

(b) Subject to appropriation, the department shall:

(1) Awards grants in an amount that does not exceed thirty thousand dollars (\$30,000) for each teacher resident participating in the residency program, up to one hundred (100) teacher residents per academic year; and

(2) Begin awarding grants to residency programs pursuant to this part beginning with the 2026-2027 academic year.

(c) Grant funds received by a residency program pursuant to this part may be used to defray all or a portion of the operating costs of the residency program, to allow the residency program to provide stipends to teacher residents, and to allow the residency program to provide stipends to mentor teachers.

(d) Partnering LEAs or public charter schools shall collaborate with EPPs or educator-related organizations to facilitate the employment of teacher residents upon their completion of the residency program and obtaining an educator license.

49-5-1204. Residency program design and components.

To receive a grant pursuant this part, a residency program must:

(1) Be designed to enrich the teaching profession and to ensure teacher residents are prepared for educator licensure;

(2) Require a teacher resident to complete at least one (1) full academic year of rigorous EPP coursework that is integrated into a concurrent full academic year of guided clinical apprenticeship in a partnering LEA or public charter school classroom under the supervision of a mentor teacher;

(3) Implement competitive admission requirements for teacher residents;

(4) Use clear criteria in the selection of mentor teachers that is based on educator effectiveness;

(5) Provide mentor teachers with evidence-based training and compensation;

(6) Group teacher residents into cohorts for professional collaboration, when practicable;

(7) Identify measures to determine the progress of teacher residents;

(8) Establish an expectation of employment for teacher residents at the partnering LEA or public charter school, or at a high-need LEA or public charter school designated by the department, if the teacher resident successfully completes the residency program, obtains an educator license, and employment positions are available at the partnering LEA or public charter school, or at a high-need LEA or public charter school designated by the department;

(9) Require teacher residents to commit to teach in a public school for a minimum of three (3) consecutive years with the partnering LEA or public charter

school, or with a high-need LEA or public charter school designated by the department, after the teacher resident successfully completes the residency program and obtains an educator license. If a teacher resident fails to complete the three-year service requirement in this subdivision (9), then the residency program shall reimburse the portion of the grant awarded to the residency program for the teacher resident in accordance with the reimbursement guidelines and requirements established by the department; and

(10) Provide support for teacher residents who complete the residency program for at least one (1) year post-completion.

49-5-1205. Relation to certain licensure requirements.

A teacher resident who successfully completes a residency program that meets the requirements in § 49-5-1204 satisfies the clinical experience required in § 49-5-5604.

49-5-1206. Reporting requirements.

(a) Residency programs that receive a grant pursuant to this part shall submit data to the department each year of the pilot program to review the program's success. The department shall notify each residency program of the data that must be submitted pursuant to this subsection (a) and the date by which the data must be submitted.

(b) By November 1, 2029, the department shall submit a report on the outcomes of the residency programs that received a grant through the pilot program using the annual data received by the department pursuant to subsection (a) to the education committee of the senate; the finance, ways and means committee of the senate; the committee of the house of representatives having jurisdiction over elementary and secondary school educators; the committee of the house of representatives having jurisdiction over financing of residency programs for educators; and the state board.

SECTION 8. The headings in this act are for reference purposes only and do not constitute a part of the law enacted by this act. However, the Tennessee Code Commission is requested to include the headings in any compilation or publication containing this act.

SECTION 9. This act is not an appropriation of funds, and funds must not be obligated or expended pursuant to this act unless the funds are specifically appropriated by the general appropriations act.

SECTION 10. Sections 1-6 of this act take effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it. All other sections of this act take effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.